TotalRecalls Unified Launch Action Plan

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1. Summary and operating rules

Launch quietly once the Phase 0 blockers are closed, then amplify only after real activation data exists. This replaces the earlier 90-day validation plan and the Day 0/Day 1 task graph, which disagreed on sequence and cadence.

One spine. Day numbers are relative to **L**, launch day, which is the first day every gate in section 5 is green. No calendar date is promised.

One primary channel, one supporting channel. YouTube demos plus the blog and guides are primary. Disclosed community posts (Reddit, later Show HN) are supporting. X and LinkedIn only repurpose existing material, at 3 posts a week.

Paused until the first review: Facebook, TikTok, Instagram, Threads, the French experiment and paid ads.

Held for a bigger moment: Product Hunt and Show HN wait until code signing is live or SmartScreen drop-off has been measured. You only get one shot at each.

Rules that apply to every asset

1. Say only what the claims register (section 3) allows or what has been recorded working.
2. Disclose that you are the developer in every personal post.
3. Tag every link with UTM parameters, except on Reddit and Hacker News, which get the clean URL.
4. Nothing is published, sent, purchased or deployed without explicit founder approval.
5. The weekly floor is 1 blog post or 1 video, 3 to 5 social posts, comment and DM replies, and an updated tracking sheet. No week carries more than one task that needs the founder's hands.

Decisions carried over from the earlier plans: launch immediately once gated, delete the 9 superseded private uploads and keep the convergence animation as channel trailer, build /blog in the Astro site, and set no revenue or traffic forecasts. The Week-8 paid gate stays as a go/no-go rule.

2. Phase 0: close these before anything goes public

The first three are facts that every asset inherits, so they come first. Most take minutes to check and days to fix. Owner key: F = founder, A = agent (orchestrator).

#	Task	Owner	Done when
0.1	Free-tier wording: find the limit in app code, test it live, then make the homepage, /download/, See It Work and FAQ say the identical thing	A, F deploys	One code reference; all four pages carry the same sentence
0.2	Discount: checkout shows $24 and $48 with no expiry. Set an expiry in Paddle (recommend L+60) and show the regular price and end date on /pricing/	F (Paddle), A (page)	Paddle shows the end date; /pricing/ shows both
0.3	Privacy audit: identify what sends the `TotalRecalls/1.0` user agent (about 40 requests in 30 days), then capture network traffic during a full download	F, A	Written list of every outbound connection; FAQ wording matches it
0.4	Per-provider export tests, all 8: what is captured (text, code, sources, attachment references) and what is not	F	Filled table, dated, with the app version
0.5	Legal review of provider terms of service, including the reply to "is this against their terms?"	F	Reviewed wording on file; no claim implies provider approval
0.6	End-to-end tests: clean Windows 10 and 11 download, ZIP contents, payment, licence key, activation on 2 to 3 machines	F	All pass; defects logged

#	Task	Owner	Done when
0.7	Measurement: decide GA4 versus Cloudflare Web Analytics (see section 4), verify UTM strings appear in the data, choose a way to count download clicks	F decides, A implements	Test event visible; UTM test link appears
0.8	YouTube: phone-verify the channel, re-authorise OAuth, delete the 9 superseded private uploads, keep the convergence animation	F, A	Upload cap lifted; token valid; 9 deleted
0.9	YouTube assets: add silent AAC to the 8 masters, rebuild 8 thumbnails from the 3440-wide masters, write 8 descriptions and pinned comments	A	Files pass ffprobe; each description has a CTA and a UTM link
0.10	Build /blog in Astro with a post template, an index and a sitemap check	A, F deploys	/blog/ and a sample post return 200 and appear in the sitemap
0.11	Email: pick the provider (Brevo, MailerLite or ConvertKit), wire the footer form, name the vendor in the privacy policy, test the welcome send	F picks, A wires	Test email arrives with a working unsubscribe
0.12	Code signing: get quotes and order an OV certificate (roughly $100 to $400 a year)	F	Order confirmation with delivery date
0.13	Record and cut the 60 to 90 second first-export walkthrough from the real app with demo data	F, A	File exists with personal data hidden

Task 0.12 is the long pole but is not a gate for the quiet launch. It is a gate for Product Hunt and Show HN.

3. Positioning and claims rules

The pitch is the demonstrated workflow, not a feature list: sign in inside the app, download your conversations, open the .md files, find them again.

One-line pitch (use everywhere): TotalRecalls is a Windows app that saves your AI conversations as Markdown and JSON files in a folder on your own PC. Supporting line: Eight AI tools. One folder on your PC. The brand line "Your AI conversations belong to you" is never used alone.

Differentiators the evidence supports

- Eight providers listed, against four for the closest one-time-price desktop competitor.
- Sign in and download directly, with no export-ZIP-then-import step. Gemini is the exception: it runs through Google Takeout and is Pro only, so never present "direct sign-in for all 8" without that note.
- Plain Markdown and JSON in a folder the user controls. Never claim this is unique, since other tools also save locally.

Allowed, in wording close to the site's: Windows 10 and 11 portable app (about 17.8 MB ZIP, no installer); no TotalRecalls account; one .md and one .json per conversation; attachment references kept but not the files; Pro is a one-time launch price with free core updates and up to 3 device activations; SHA-256 published on the Download page; the site's three privacy sentences, quoted verbatim, only after task 0.3 confirms them.

Never say

- "Safe", "secure", "100% private", "virus-free" or "trusted by Windows".
- "The only", "the first" or "unlike every other tool".
- That attachments or images are downloaded.
- That add-ons exist or have dates, or that Mac and Linux have dates.
- Anything implying a provider endorses or partners with the app.
- "Just click Run anyway, it's fine." SmartScreen is always framed as: what it is, how to check the file, how to continue.

Record before you claim: speed, very large histories, "catches what official exports miss", and what each provider's files contain. These wait for tasks 0.4 and 0.13.

Free-tier line. Until task 0.1 settles it, every asset uses one placeholder, {FREE_LINE}. Never write a multiplied figure such as 15 free conversations.

Publish an honest "who should not pay" section on the site: someone who uses one AI tool and wants an occasional copy may be fine with the provider's own export. It filters refunds and builds trust.

Recording rules: demo accounts with 15 to 30 harmless chats, a fresh Windows profile, blurred emails and titles, real SmartScreen shown, captions burned into short video, no provider logos in thumbnails, and the not-affiliated line in every description.

4. Measurement plan

The current traffic numbers cannot support targets. Last week's roughly 1,489 visits exclude only one automated user agent; crawlers, curl and headless browsers remain, and 46 to 57 percent of visits have an unknown operating system. So the plan sets no numeric targets for the first two weeks and measures instead.

Rules

1. Every report excludes any user agent containing TotalRecallsAudit and shows a second view that also excludes Cloudflare-verified bots.
2. Pageviews on /download/ are page loads, never downloads. Gate thresholds are set only from measured download clicks.
3. Resolve the tracking conflict before launch. The site promises no analytics and no tracking pixels, and the app promises no telemetry. GA4 contradicts that for a privacy-minded audience. Recommended: Cloudflare Web Analytics (cookieless, gives referrers) plus UTM tags and a download-click event. If you keep GA4, update the site wording first.
4. Do not add usage telemetry to the app for activation tracking. That is a product and privacy decision, not a marketing one.

Funnel and how each stage is measured

Stage	Measure	Limit
Site visit	Cloudflare zone analytics via API, exclusions applied	Includes unidentified bots
Download click	Link event (task 0.7)	A click is not an install
First export	Voluntary feedback link, support emails, 5 to 10 watched sessions	Small samples; no automatic count

Stage	Measure	Limit
Pro purchase	Paddle records, matched to campaign by UTM and date	Free-to-Pro cannot be linked per person without an account
Refunds and support	Paddle, inbox	More than 5 percent refunds means an expectation mismatch

Review points. L+7 and L+14 are fix-the-funnel checkpoints with no numeric gate. L+28 sets the first thresholds from observed data. L+56 is the formal review of click-through, view duration, free-to-pro conversion and signups. Tracking sheet columns per asset: ID, channel, date, UTM content, views, engagement, visits, download clicks, purchases, top questions.

Paid go/no-go rule (kept): paid promotion starts only if free-to-Pro is at least 8 percent and click-through is at least 3 percent. Before running it, define how free-to-Pro is counted, and set the CAC kill line against real margin. About $22 net per sale means a $24 CAC loses money; the earlier working ceiling was $8 to $11.

5. Launch gate checklist

L is the first day every item in the quiet-launch list is ticked.

Quiet-launch gates (all required)

- [ ] 0.1 Free-tier wording identical on every page
- [ ] 0.2 Discount expiry set in Paddle and shown on /pricing/ with the regular price
- [ ] 0.3 Privacy audit done; "no telemetry" wording confirmed or corrected
- [ ] 0.4 All 8 provider exports tested; claims limited to what was recorded
- [ ] 0.5 Provider-terms review done
- [ ] 0.6 Download, payment, licence and activation tested on clean machines
- [ ] 0.7 Measurement live: UTM visible, download-click event firing
- [ ] 0.8 YouTube verified, token valid, 9 old uploads deleted
- [ ] 0.9 Eight masters, thumbnails, descriptions and pinned comments ready; each description checked against section 3
- [ ] 0.10 /blog live and in the sitemap
- [ ] 0.11 Email provider wired and test send green
- [ ] Support email visible on the site and refund terms readable

- [ ] A SmartScreen guide with screenshots is on the site, framed as a reputation check

Amplification gates (Product Hunt, Show HN, paid)

- [ ] Code signing live, or SmartScreen drop-off measured and judged acceptable
- [ ] At least 5 watched first-export sessions completed without help
- [ ] Support tickets per new user are stable and manageable
- [ ] Refund rate below 5 percent
- [ ] Thresholds for downloads and conversion set from at least 2 weeks of measured data
- [ ] Founder has a clear day for Product Hunt (launch is 03:01 Eastern) or a Hacker News morning slot

6. Timeline

Phase 0 targets about 48 hours if the blockers are quick, but L moves with the gates, not the calendar.

Day	Action	Owner	Gate
Phase 0	Section 2 tasks 0.1 to 0.13; watched first-export sessions with 3 to 5 testers	F, A	Section 5 quiet-launch list
L	Publish blog post B1 (launch announcement); make the 8 provider videos public in the Start Here playlist with thumbnails and pinned comments; set the convergence animation as channel trailer; send welcome email	A, F approves	Each publish approved
L	One disclosed community post (r/SideProject), clean URL, founder online 2 to 3 hours	F	Subreddit rules re-read that day
L+1 to L+7	X thread of the 5-step workflow (X1), LinkedIn product post (L1), 2 to 3 Shorts cut from the Claude master, directory submissions (AlternativeTo)	F posts, A stages	Weekly batch approval

Day	Action	Owner	Gate
L+5	Blog B2 (Library folder) and founder story	A, F	Approved
L+7	Checkpoint: downloads, first-export signals, tickets, purchases. Fix the top drop-off before adding effort	A	None
L+8	Video V6 ("Trying to Get Your Old AI Conversations Back?"); then one video a week	F shoots, A edits	Description checked
L+9	r/ClaudeAI value post, disclosed	F	Rules checked
L+14	Checkpoint 2; review the watched-session notes; update the reply bank	A	None
L+15	Blog B3 (Markdown vs JSON); upgrade ChatGPT, Claude and Perplexity guides with embedded videos	A	Deploy approved
L+22, L+29, L+36	Blog B4 (privacy; second-person review first), B5 (backup library), B6 (Windows search) plus an r/windows post	A, F	Deploy approved
L+28	First thresholds set from measured data. Decide on Product Hunt, Show HN and signing status	F	Amplification gates
L+42	"Launch pricing ends soon" post and urgency email, pointing at the real expiry	A, F	Task 0.2 done
L+43, L+50, L+57	Blog B7 (organizing by project), B8 (Obsidian) with r/ObsidianMD post, B9 (VS Code)	A, F	Deploy approved

Day	Action	Owner	Gate
L+56	Week-8 review; paid go/no-go using the rule in section 4	A	Paid spend approved separately
L+60	Launch discount expires (recommended)	F	None
Certificate arrives	Sign the EXE, rebuild, publish new ZIP and checksum, update /download/ wording; announce only after it is live	A, F	Deploy approved
L+57 to L+84	Founder video, first product update video, Obsidian video only if it has been tested in Obsidian	F	None
L+90	Quarter checkpoint: CAC, conversion, refunds, support load, macOS and Linux messaging	A, F	None

7. Channel playbooks

The v2 content pack stays the copy source: scripts, post drafts, reply banks and the checklist keep their asset IDs. This section says which of them are live.

Channel	Role	What runs	Notes
YouTube	Primary	8 provider demos at L, the V6 script at L+8, one video a week after, 2 to 3 Shorts, comment replies within 24 hours	Each video links its site guide with a UTM tag; descriptions end with the standard footer
Blog and guides	Primary	B1 to B9 on the schedule in section 6; embed each video in its guide	Short answer, steps, then a "keep it on your machine" close

Channel	Role	What runs	Notes
Reddit and Show HN	Supporting	Disclosed, value-first posts, one per venue, rewritten for each community	Clean URL; read each subreddit's rules on the day; never repeat text
Email	Supporting	Welcome at L; free-to-Pro sequence triggered by behaviour; real-news updates only	Provider must be named in the privacy policy
X and LinkedIn	Repurposing	3 posts a week recycled from video and blog; X1 thread; L1 product post	Check post length after filling placeholders
Directories	Low effort	AlternativeTo and AI-tool roundups, one submission each	Only after the site is stable
Product Hunt, Show HN	Held	Decide at L+28 using the amplification gates	Ask for feedback, never votes
Facebook, TikTok, Instagram, Threads, French	Paused	Revisit at the L+56 review; re-use Shorts if capacity allows	Mobile CTAs have a weak path for a Windows-only app

Weekly rhythm. Monday: plan and stage the week's assets. During the week: publish the video or blog post, post 3 to 5 social items, answer comments. Friday: update the tracking sheet and log new objections into the reply bank and FAQ.

Pre-publish check for every asset: claims match section 3; the free-tier line is the settled one; "I'm the developer" is visible; the not-affiliated line is present; UTM tags are correct; personal data is hidden; community rules were re-read; no vote requests.

8. Risks, budget and open decisions

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation	Owner
SmartScreen or Smart App Control blocks trials	High	Order the certificate now; keep the SmartScreen guide prominent; hold Product Hunt and Show HN until signed or measured	F
Provider terms or a takedown complaint	Medium	Task 0.5 review; never imply approval; prepared reply	F
Provider interface change breaks a download	Medium	Re-test exports after provider updates; fast fix notes; status line on the site	F, A
Free-tier or price wording confuses buyers	Medium	Tasks 0.1 and 0.2 before any asset ships	F
"No telemetry" claim contradicted by observed traffic	Medium	Task 0.3 before any privacy-verification content	F
Claims outrun tested reality	Medium	Task 0.4 and the pre-publish check	A
Unidentified bots distort metrics	High	Exclusions in every report; judge on download clicks and purchases	A
Solo-operator overload	High	Weekly floor; paused channels; batch community work	F
Reddit backlash	Medium	Disclose; follow rules; 90 percent value posts	F

Budget. Phase 0 cost is the certificate only (about $100 to $400 a year; get a quote). Domain, hosting, email free tier and all organic channels are $0. Paid promotion starts only after the L+56 rule passes. If used, cap at $10 a day on the hero video with a hard stop at the CAC ceiling.

Open decisions for the founder

1. Tracking: Cloudflare Web Analytics (recommended) or GA4 with updated site wording.

2. Free-tier wording: per download or per provider, decided by the app's real behaviour.
3. Email provider.
4. Whether to treat code signing as required before Product Hunt (recommended).
5. Whether the convergence animation stays as trailer or is replaced.
6. Target for YouTube subscribers, if any, after L+28.

Sources: the TotalRecalls Market Launch Master Plan v2 (Oct 23, 2026), including its website-stated product facts, Cloudflare baseline and content pack. Nothing here has been independently tested.